

Managing and Updating the Casa Refugiados App

A Step-by-Step Guide for Staff and Volunteers

Overview

This guide explains how to update the text, resources, and translations within the Casa Refugiados app. The application was specifically designed as a single-file system so that staff and volunteers can update the content without needing any prior programming experience.

Understanding the Setup

The app relies on two main platforms that communicate seamlessly with each other:

1. **GitHub:** Think of this as your master filing cabinet. It holds the actual text, translations, and layout of the app. When you need to add a resource, fix a typo, or update guidance, you do it here.
2. **Netlify:** Think of this as the broadcaster. It takes the files stored in GitHub and publishes them to the internet at `https://casarefugiados.netlify.app/`.

Because these two systems are linked, **you almost never need to log into Netlify**. Netlify watches your GitHub repository 24/7. The moment you save a change in GitHub, Netlify automatically updates the live website.

Part 1: Updating the Weekly Schedule

(No GitHub Required)

Before editing any files, note that the live weekly schedule for La Casita is powered entirely by a published Google Sheet.

- To update the events, times, or community programs, simply edit the linked Google Sheet.
- You do not need to touch GitHub or Netlify to change the schedule. The app will automatically pull the newest data directly from the spreadsheet.

Part 2: Editing App Content in GitHub

For all other updates—such as changing medical care information, adding legal resources, or refining the Spanish, Arabic, or Haitian Creole translations—you will edit the app directly through your web browser on GitHub.

Step 1: Open the Main File

1. Open your web browser and navigate to the project repository: `https://github.com/jcarte26-ctrl/casa-refugiados-app` (Note: Ensure you are logged into a GitHub account that has edit permissions for this repository).
2. Look at the list of files and click on the main HTML file (it will be named `index.html` or `index (3).html`).

Step 2: Enter Edit Mode

1. Once the file is open, look at the top-right corner of the code box.
2. Click the small **pencil icon** (Edit this file). The screen will turn into an editable text box.

Step 3: Locate the Text to Change

1. To keep the app entirely offline-capable, all the text lives near the top of this single file. The content is clearly grouped by language.
2. Instead of scrolling manually, use **Ctrl + F** (or **Cmd + F** on a Mac) to search for the specific word, sentence, or resource you want to update.

Step 4: Make Your Edits Carefully

- **The Golden Rule:** You must only change the standard text that sits *inside* the quotation marks (`" "`).
- **Do not delete any formatting symbols.** Be very careful not to accidentally delete commas `,`, brackets `[ ]`, or curly braces `{ }`. These symbols tell the app how to organize the information. If they are removed, the app may display a blank screen.

Example of a safe edit:

Current: `"description": "Provides legal assistance for asylum seekers."`

New: `"description": "Provides free legal assistance and housing guidance."`

Step 5: Save (Commit) Your Changes

1. Once you are happy with the text updates, look to the top-right of the screen for a green button that says **Commit changes...**
2. Click it, and a small box will pop up.
3. In the first text box, write a brief, clear summary of what you did so other staff members know what changed (e.g., *"Updated clinic hours in the Spanish section"* or *"Fixed a typo in the legal resources"*).
4. Click the green **Commit changes** button to finalize your work.

Part 3: Verifying the Update on Netlify

Once you click "Commit changes" in GitHub, your work is done!

1. Netlify will automatically detect the new save and begin rebuilding the app behind the scenes.
2. Wait about 2 to 3 minutes.
3. Open `https://casarefugiados.netlify.app/` on your phone or computer.
4. Refresh the page, and you will see your updated information live.

Optional Troubleshooting: *If you ever need to manually verify that the site is running, or if an update isn't showing up, you can log into Netlify.com, click on the Casa Refugiados project, and view the "Site deploys" tab. This page provides a timestamped log of every successful update.*